

# Roshi — Ispin's Green Shield

*Vestige of Divergence · Drafted 2026-10-06 · Before Session 12*

Apart from what is listed under What the Table Has Seen, nothing here is player-known. None of it goes on the player pages or in a recap.

## AT A GLANCE

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| NOW              | A +1 shield that can wrap Roshi in the illusion of a boulder or a tree.                                                                                         |
| AFTER SESSION 12 | <b>Slumbering.</b> The bear den is its first memory.                                                                                                            |
| IDENTITY         | The shield answers Roshi's memories of Ispin. Each memory she tells at the table can become an ability. In a stranger's hands it is only a +1 shield.           |
| INSPIRATION      | Frieren. Roshi is Frieren and Ispin is Himmel. Her question is what she lives for now.                                                                          |
| SIBLING          | Built on the same skeleton as Aratos's Leviathan Axe, so the two feel like a pair.                                                                              |
| OPEN WORK        | Stirring and Awakened are sketches. Nothing yet says what moves the shield from one stage to the next. The stage bonuses need the same balance pass as the axe. |

### TABLE CARD · SESSION 12

1. **Trigger.** The first time a light wave falls on her, or on anyone within 5 feet of her.
2. **Memory.** The story she told at his funeral comes to mind: the bear den. Ask what she does.
3. **If she steps in.** The light breaks on the shield. Nobody is taken by that wave. Boyd sees it.
4. **The bear den wakes,** free, until the spell breaks.
5. **On the Stone.** When her attack hits and she bashes, the Stone is knocked flat and loses its next Slam.
6. **If she is taken first.** Marigold looks at the shield and says someone is in there.

## THE RULE OF THE SHIELD

- **It answers memory.** The shield reacts to what its bearer remembers of Ispin. Someone who did not know him gets a +1 shield and nothing more.
- **The memory has to be hers.** She was there. Tall tales told by others do not count, though she can go and learn what really happened.
- **She tells it, you build it.** When Roshi's player tells a memory of Ispin in character, you turn it into one ability and name it after the story.
- **It speaks in memories.** There is a little of Ispin in the shield, and for now it reaches her only by bringing a memory to mind. It nudges her toward protecting people and stays quiet on puzzles.
- **Keep it apart from the axe.** Cathan tests and judges Aratos. The shield is warm, and it asks nothing.

### Building an Ability from a Memory

- **Cost:** one leaf for most. Two for something that changes a whole fight.
- **Size:** one leaf buys about what a 2nd-level spell does, for a minute or for one big moment.
- **Shape:** take the one impossible thing that happened in the story and let it happen again.

- **Lane:** her paladin features already take hits and saves for other people. Give the shield things an oath does not do.

## WHAT THE TABLE HAS SEEN

| SESSION | WHAT HAPPENED                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4       | Ispin left the shield to Fizban, who declined it and said it needed someone who would stand on the front line. Roshi asked for it.                              |
| 4       | Becklin gave it to her at Thornwall Keep. It felt as though the shield had come home, and she learned it was magical.                                           |
| 4       | She found it could wrap her in the illusion of a boulder or a tree.                                                                                             |
| 4       | At the funeral her player told the bear den story: Ispin ate the honey in the den and waited to thank the bears, they woke hungry, and she wrestled the mother. |
| 5       | Among the wounded, Ispin's presence felt close.                                                                                                                 |
| 8       | In the river she saw Ispin ask whether she had protected his people. She answered that she had done what she could.                                             |

Not confirmed as played: the vignette prepared for Journey 010 in which the painted tree on the shield has grown a new branch and leaves. Also the dreams of Ispin and the flower crown, which are from the table and are not in any chat.

## SLUMBERING

### Ispin's Green Shield (Slumbering)

*Shield, +1 · requires attunement by someone who remembers Ispin*

**Green Disguise.** As played: she can wrap herself in the illusion of a boulder or a tree.

**A Life Worth Living.** Once per long rest, when she would drop to 0 hit points, she drops to 1 instead.

**Shield Bash.** After she hits a creature with a melee weapon attack, she can use a bonus action to bash it. The target makes a Strength saving throw (DC 8 + her proficiency bonus + her Strength modifier). On a failure she pushes it 5 feet or knocks it prone. The target can be up to one size larger than her.

**Leaves:** 2 (regained on a long rest). They show as leaves on the painted tree.

**Memories:** 1.

**The Bear Den, 1 leaf.** Bonus action, lasts 1 minute. She has advantage on Strength checks and Strength saving throws, and she cannot be moved or knocked prone against her will. Her Shield Bash works on a creature of any size, pushes it 15 feet and knocks it prone, and deals an extra 1d8 bludgeoning damage.

## STIRRING AND AWAKENED (SKETCHES)

| STAGE             | BONUS | LEAVES | MEMORIES | CHANGE                                                                          |
|-------------------|-------|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Slumbering</b> | +1    | 2      | 1        | As above.                                                                       |
| <b>Stirring</b>   | +2    | 4      | 3        | The shield gives her a word or two in his voice. Shield Bash pushes 10 feet.    |
| <b>Awakened</b>   | +3    | 6      | 5        | Real conversation. The fifth memory is one of her own, from her life after him. |

The last stage is the answer to her question. The shield stops being a record of his life and starts recording hers.

## BESIDE THE AXE

| PART           | LEVIATHAN AXE (SLUMBERING)      | GREEN SHIELD (SLUMBERING)       |
|----------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Bonus          | +1 weapon, +1d4 cold            | +1 shield                       |
| Signature      | Embed and Recall                | Green Disguise                  |
| Passive        | Frost Memory, King's Perimeter  | A Life Worth Living             |
| Rider on a hit | Topple                          | Shield Bash                     |
| Charges        | 2 frost charges                 | 2 leaves                        |
| Charge spend   | Freezing Throw                  | The Bear Den                    |
| What feeds it  | His restraint, tested by Cathan | Her memories, told at the table |

## MEMORY LOG

| MEMORY       | TOLD                   | ABILITY      | LEAVES |
|--------------|------------------------|--------------|--------|
| The bear den | Session 4, the funeral | The Bear Den | 1      |

**Where new memories come from.** Her time in Kalaman with Fizban. He knew Ispin too, and every story she trades with him can wake a leaf.

**Tales told by others at the funeral.** These are not hers, so they do not count as they stand. Any of them could become hers if she turns out to have been there.

- He rode down a volcano on this shield (a villager).
- He jumped off a mountain into three feet of water and lived (a villager).
- The wyrmling in the cavern and the leap into the ravine (Becklin).
- The stolen pie that hit the prince (Fizban).

## THREADS

- **Fizban.** Wyhan's note says he is asking for "your wand and shield." That now reads as him wanting time with his old friend.
- **Marigold.** She collects souls. If she sees the shield she knows someone is in it.
- **Boyd.** He saw the shield decades ago on Becklin's posting. He should be the one who sees it wake.
- **The painted tree.** Its leaves are the charges. A new leaf appears each time the shield wakes further.
- **The flower crown.** Her oath has her making a Forever Flowercrown. Its flowers could come from the shield's tree.

## OPEN QUESTIONS

- What moves the shield from Slumbering to Stirring, and from Stirring to Awakened?
- Do the +2 and +3 stages stay, given what a +3 shield does to her armor class?
- Does Green Disguise need written rules, or does it stay as ruled at the table?
- Is the painted tree's new growth shown tonight, or held for later? Has she started the Forever Flowercrown?

## OATH OF THE FLOWERCROWN: NOTES FOR A REWRITE

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Roshi's oath is a homebrew from 2020. Her player's time away is a good window to rewrite it. These are notes, and nothing is decided.

### What It Is Now

| PART                     | WHERE IT COMES FROM                                                  |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tenets                   | Oath of the Crown, with kindness and hospitality added.              |
| Spell list               | Oath of the Crown, with a few swaps. Crown of madness is an odd fit. |
| Channel Divinity         | Oath of Vengeance: Abjure Enemy and Vow of Enmity.                   |
| Level 7, Self-Sacrifice  | Oath of the Crown's Divine Allegiance.                               |
| Level 15, Guardian Angel | Oath of Redemption's Protective Spirit.                              |
| Level 20                 | Oath of Conquest. The text still says "avatar of conquest."          |

- **Every feature is borrowed**, and none of them expresses flowers, hospitality, kindness or memory.
- **The Vengeance options fit the tenets poorly**, and Vow of Enmity is among the strongest any oath has.

### Why the Oath of Misfortune Is the Model

- **One resource:** Jinx charges, from level 3.
- **One tag:** "cursed." Every later feature keys off it.
- **Tenets that say how she fights.**
- **Its one hot spot:** Jinx a Creature costs no action, allows no save, and can name an ability used for saving throws. If it ever needs trimming, limit it to attack rolls and ability checks, or add a Charisma save.

### A Direction

Make it the mirror of Misfortune. Misfortune curses enemies. Flowercrown blesses the people under her care.

- **Resource:** flowers in the crown, a few per long rest.
- **Tag:** "guest." Giving someone a flower puts them under her hospitality.
- **What features key off:** her protection reaches guests further and works better on them.
- **Level 7:** keep Self-Sacrifice. It already fits.
- **Channel Divinity:** one option about shelter and one about courage, in place of the two from Vengeance.
- **Spell list:** drop crown of madness.
- **Wording:** Misfortune is written in 2024 terms and the table runs 2014 classes. Write this one in 2014 terms unless the conversion starts here.

**How the oath and the shield divide the work.** The oath decides who she protects. The shield is how his memory helps her do it.